GC Home Service — Forward Marketing Calendar (Internal)

August 2026 – February 2027

INTERNAL ONLY. Ticket ask: proactive forward planning instead of month-to-month reaction. Built 2026-08-05 off the 2026-07-31 weekly close (`weekly-log-2026-07-31.md`, `google-ads-log.md`, `README.md`). No client-supplied brief or marketing calendar exists — this is standard Zone 5/6 HVAC seasonal doctrine (cooling to Labor Day, fall maintenance Sept–Oct, winter emergency Nov–Feb) layered onto this account's actual performance data. Flagging inference where it matters.

No total budget figure is on file anywhere in this repo — only individual campaign daily budgets (Google PMax $50/day post-cut, Meta awareness $20/day, etc.). Dollar figures below are deliberately left as sequence/ratio, not commitments — any real shift still needs the written client-approval ticket per MasterOps hard rule #1. If a client-approved monthly number ever exists, redo this as ratios against it (Lilypad Q4 precedent: `clients/lilypad-septic/media-plan-q4-2026.md`).

The Season This Is Built Around

Cincinnati tri-state HVAC demand runs on a predictable clock: cooling carries through Labor Day, September–October is the fall maintenance/tune-up window, and the first hard cold snap (usually around Thanksgiving) flips demand to no-heat emergencies through the coldest months. Every phase below is sequenced against that, not against whichever channel had a slow week.

30-Day Plan — Aug 5 to Sep 4

Focus: close out cooling while the fall push's foundation lands. This window leans on three open items that are already blockers today, not new work:

1. **Landing page approval — still awaiting the client**, open since before 07-31. Blocks the Google quality/rank play (68.5% of PMax impression share lost to Ad Rank, not budget — landing page relevance is the lever) and is the only planned fix for the dead form path (`Form Submision [Landing Page]`, 0 fires/90d). **If this doesn't land inside 30 days, the fall Search relaunch slips with it** — don't launch fall creative onto an unapproved destination.
2. **Service area list reconciliation — unresolved since 2026-07-13.** Google's list and Meta's list don't match (`README.md` §Service area). "Amelia, KY" and "Williamsburg, KY" have been escalated twice with no answer. This also gates direct mail (below) and the still-live problem that Meta targeting is sitting on Manuel's Jul 8 dropped-pin overwrite (Newport KY +40km), not the city/ZIP list Edu adjudicated by hand on Jul 13 — that decision (real city list vs. formal radius rescope) needs to close here too.
3. **ServiceTitan / offline conversion import — not built, zero upload-origin conversion actions exist today** (same gap as Golden Plumbing, Proud Pops). Start the connection now so November's bidding — the highest-value month of the year — optimizes on booked jobs, not

call-button clicks. This is also why weather-triggered budget response (below) is sequenced to the 90-day window and not sooner: reacting fast to a signal on top of a thin/dirty conversion base is the same mistake as the Jul 16 PMax 3x bump (Andrea raised it to $155/day while bidding on call-button clicks; it bled ~$963 for 1 conversion before the Jul 28 cut to $50). A weather trigger is a faster version of the same lever — don't hand it dirty signal.

4. **Paper the overdue AM ticket** for the Jul 28 PMax budget cut ($155→$50/day, executed on Edu's verbal authority, still undocumented as of 07-31). Should not still be open when this calendar starts generating its own budget-change tickets.

Seasonal/creative in parallel: - Keep AC repair/replacement live through Labor Day (Sep 7) — last real cooling-demand week. - Relaunch Meta lead gen on the consolidated offer: **quote-back ($1,500) leads the new batch** — it's the only creative in the account with real signal ($47.16 CPL, 2.67% CTR, though thin at 5 leads/$235 spend). One DCT ad set per angle, per doctrine. - Soft-launch early-bird fall tune-up messaging alongside cooling. **Do not sell the $99 tune-up standalone** — it pulled 1 lead at $432.52, the worst CPL in the account, when it ran alone in July. Bundle it into a fuller system-check offer this time.

By day 30: foundation closed (or explicitly flagged as still open, with a new date), fall creative in production, quote-back-anchored Meta batch live.

60-Day Plan — Aug 5 to Oct 4

Focus: fall maintenance live across every channel. - Furnace tune-up campaign live on Search — relaunch the paused nonbranded campaign (`TSD_07.05_Search_Nonbranded_Cooling` retired/replaced) themed to furnace/no-heat prevention terms, with the negatives list (competitors, junk-intent terms) carried over from the June/July cleanup rather than rebuilt from scratch. - Meta tune-up ad set live, bundled offer per the 30-day note above. - PMax asset groups refreshed to fall service lines; keep the $50/day budget as the floor until conversion signal (form path fixed, ServiceTitan connected) justifies moving it — don't repeat the Jul 16 bump-before-proof pattern. - Direct mail creative and mail-house partner locked, targeted at the finalized service area list from the 30-day item. Vendor is not sourced yet — this is a real task for whoever picks it up. - Weather-trigger logic built and run in **shadow mode only** (logging, no live budget changes) against the season's first cool nights.

90-Day Plan — Aug 5 to Nov 3

Focus: pre-winter push and the first live weather-triggered campaign. - Financing-led messaging becomes the primary offer heading into the holidays. - Thanksgiving week (Nov 26) no-heat/emergency positioning goes live — the tri-state's first real cold-snap-driven demand spike. - First direct mail drop (EDDM to the finalized service area) lands early November, ahead of Thanksgiving week, carrying a furnace/no-heat offer. Trackable via a dedicated number or promo code — same measurement discipline as the paid channels, not "however it feels." - Weather-triggered campaigns go live for real — budget/bid response, not just logging — *only if*

the shadow-mode test came back clean and ServiceTitan/offline conversions are live by then. If either isn't ready, hold weather-triggers in shadow mode rather than force the date. - Booked-job tracking should be live by this point, so November — the highest-value month before deep winter — is bidding on outcomes verifiable against GC's own books.

Weather-Triggered Campaigns — Mechanism

Cincinnati weather is the best leading indicator this account has: a run of 90°+ days in cooling season or a hard cold snap in heating season moves call volume before search volume catches up. Mechanism: define trigger thresholds per season (e.g. sustained 90°+ for 2+ days May–Sept for AC emergency; ≤20°F or a cold-snap/freeze advisory Nov–Mar for no-heat emergency), and when a public forecast feed (NWS or a free-tier API like OpenWeatherMap — no vendor research done, small-account scale, no enterprise weather-ad platform needed) crosses them, temporarily lift Search budget and pin a weather-referencing RSA headline, mirrored with a short Meta budget lift on the live lead campaign. Build as a Google Ads Script on a schedule, reviewed by hand before each seasonal window rather than fully automatic from day one. **Deliberately sequenced behind the ServiceTitan/offline conversion fix** — see the Jul 16 PMax lesson above. Fast reaction on dirty signal just buys faster mistakes.

Direct Mail — Future Opportunity

Three plays, sequenced by readiness, all gated on the service-area list reconciliation:

1. **EDDM neighborhood drop.** First run early November, ahead of Thanksgiving/first cold snap, furnace/no-heat offer. Needs a mail-house partner (not sourced) and finalized creative.
2. **Customer maintenance reminder.** Once ServiceTitan/booked-job history is connected, mail past customers due for a tune-up — cheapest per piece, warmest list, ties to the existing "Repeat Phone Call" demand already seen in the account's own conversion data.
3. **New-mover mailer.** Ongoing monthly drop to recent movers into the service area — standard, well-proven HVAC direct-mail trigger.

All three carry a dedicated phone number or promo code for attribution — don't launch a channel that inherits the same measurement gap Google and Meta are currently working through.

180-Day Seasonal Roadmap — Aug 2026 to Feb 2027

Month	Season Phase	Lead Offer / Angle	Google	Meta	Direct Mail / Other
Aug	Late cooling / foundation	AC repair & replacement; early-bird tune-up soft launch	Branded Search + PMax ($50/d floor); foundation work; nonbranded fall relaunch prepped	Lead gen relaunched on quote-back; awareness continues ($20/d)	Service area list reconciled; AM ticket for PMax cut papered
Sep	Fall maintenance opens	Furnace tune-up (bundled, never standalone $99)	Nonbranded fall terms live; PMax assets refreshed	Tune-up ad set live	Mail creative + mail house locked
Oct	Furnace tune-ups peak	Tune-up + financing intro	Full fall lineup live; weather-trigger shadow mode	Tune-up + financing test	First EDDM drop prepped
Nov	Pre-winter / first cold snap	No-heat emergency + financing; Thanksgiving week push	Weather-trigger live (if gates clear); branded + emergency terms	Emergency + financing	EDDM drop 1 lands (early Nov)
Dec	Winter promotions	Gift-of-comfort/financing early month; emergency through holidays	Emergency terms; weather-trigger active	Holiday financing + emergency	Customer maintenance reminder mailer (needs ServiceTitan live)
Jan	Peak winter emergency	No-heat, same-day, coldest-month positioning	Weather-trigger primary lever	Emergency-led	New-mover mailer ongoing
Feb	Transition	President's Day financing event; early AC tune-up pre-sell	Shift back toward cooling terms	Transition creative	Review results, draft spring calendar

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Open items / next step

- [ ] Landing page approval (blocks fall Search relaunch)
- [ ] Service area reconciliation + Meta geo decision (blocks direct mail + accurate fall geo)
- [ ] ServiceTitan offline conversion import (blocks weather-trigger go-live + clean Nov bidding)
- [ ] AM ticket: paper the overdue PMax budget-cut record

- [ ] AM ticket: get this calendar in front of the client with explicit deadlines on the three gates above tied to the 30/60/90-day windows — nothing here is a commitment until they sign off, and no date should be treated as fixed if a gate slips.
- [ ] Source a direct-mail vendor/mail-house — not yet identified.
- [ ] If the *July Campaign Management, Budget Allocation & Lead Quality Review* doc ever surfaces (never supplied, searched 07-31, not found), check this calendar against it — it may already define seasonal commitments TSD is on the hook for.